



# **OROFACIAL AESTHETIC GUIDELINE**

**REVISED 2025**

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## INTRODUCTION

Over recent years, the provision of non-surgical/surgical facial aesthetics has emerged as a key growth area within healthcare delivery in the world. An increasing number of healthcare professionals now offer treatments designed to refresh facial appearance by immobilizing facial muscles or providing subcutaneous fillers. The use of Botulinum toxin injections and facial fillers are currently increasing within the dental practice. The dental surgeons are well versed with facial and jaw anatomy, and they are in a good position to help rejuvenate their patients' facial appearance on patient's request.

The aesthetic treatment rendered by the dental practitioner may vary from simple non-invasive procedures to surgical interventions. Due to the different modes of treatment for facial aesthetics and level of invasiveness of the treatment, the Malaysian Dental Council (MDC) believe these procedures should be regulated and monitored. This document serves as a guideline on aesthetic facial procedures for dental practitioners. It does not include aesthetic dental procedures such as teeth whitening, veneers, crowns, bridges, dental implants and core oral and maxillofacial procedures.

## **1. DEFINITION**

Oral facial aesthetic procedures include all invasive/non-invasive medical/surgical procedures which are non-pathological conditions where the primary aim is to change, improve and enhance appearance within the oral and maxillofacial region/domain at the request of an individual/patient. Pathological, functional and corrective surgical procedures in the orofacial region are not deemed as orofacial aesthetic practices.

## **2. AESTHETIC TREATMENT**

Aesthetic treatments may be categorized according to:

### **i. Non-Invasive/Minimally Invasive**

- a. Procedures may be permanent or reversible. Procedures may involve pre-prepared/manufactured approved injectable items to the orofacial region only.
- b. Minimally invasive procedures to only involve epidermis skin and connective tissue. These procedures involve penetration or transgression of integument but are limited to the sub- dermis and subcutaneous fat; not extending beyond the superficial musculo-aponeurotic layer of the face and neck, or beyond the superficial fascial layer.

## ii. Invasive

- a. Procedures that require use of laser, radiofrequency, chemical peel (deep peel), dermabrasion,
- b. Procedures such as facial lift with threads, blepharoplasty, minor surgical rhinoplasty and augmentation procedures, cheiloplasty or any procedures that only require local anaesthetic without intravenous sedations. Patients can be seen as outpatients at any approved facility.
- c. Procedures that may require intravenous sedation or general anaesthesia and hospital admission.

## 3. DESIGNATION OF OROFACIAL AESTHETIC PRACTICE

Orofacial Aesthetic Practice is not regarded as a specialty or subspecialty. The title of aesthetic oral and maxillofacial surgeon or orofacial aesthetic practitioner is therefore **NOT** allowed. A dental practitioner who provides and performs orofacial aesthetic procedures shall still be designated as a dental surgeon. A dental practitioner who is an oral and maxillofacial surgeon who provides and performs orofacial aesthetic procedures shall still be designated as oral and maxillofacial surgeon. All registered dental practitioners

are to comply with the Code of Professional Conduct issued by the MDC when displaying or using any qualification, title or designation for public information purposes.

## **4. PREREQUISITE FOR OROFACIAL AESTHETIC PRACTICE**

### **4.1 The practitioner**

#### **4.1.1 The practitioner must fulfil the following:**

- a. A dental surgeon who intends to practice orofacial aesthetics must be registered with the MDC.
- b. minimum of five (5) years of clinical experience as a dental practitioner and subsequently.
- c. completed relevant recognized training in orofacial aesthetic practice by the MDC.

#### **4.1.2 The dental practitioner must possess a current and valid practicing certificate.**

#### **4.1.3 The dental practitioner must exercise strict patient selection criteria, must communicate to the potential patient the risks involved and document these risks and the possible outcome. Obtain informed consent for the orofacial aesthetic procedure planned and observe all**

aspects of the MDC Code of Professional Conduct.

**4.1.4** The dental practitioner must place patient safety as the primary concern and should provide Orofacial aesthetic services in a public healthcare facility and private healthcare facility licensed or registered under the Private Healthcare Facilities Services Act 1998 [Act 586], Private Healthcare Facilities and Services (Private Hospitals and Other Private Healthcare Facilities] Regulations 2006 and Private Healthcare Facilities and Services (Private Medical Clinics or Private Dental Clinics) Regulations 2006.

## **4.2 The Facility**

**4.2.1** The dental practitioner must place patient safety as the primary concern and should provide Orofacial aesthetic services in a public healthcare facility and private healthcare facility licensed or registered under Act 586, Private Healthcare Facilities and Services (Private Hospitals and Other Private Healthcare Facilities] Regulations 2006 and Private Healthcare Facilities and Services (Private Medical Clinics or Private Dental Clinics) Regulations 2006.



**4.2.2** The private healthcare facility must list the service of orofacial aesthetic as per requirement under Act 586.

4.2.2.1 The aesthetic procedures can only be performed by a credentialed practitioner in a healthcare facility as mentioned in 4.2.2.

4.2.2.2 Healthcare facilities are:

- a. Dental Clinic or Dental Specialist Clinic;
- b. Ambulatory Care Centre with Minor Surgery Room (MSR) or Operation Theatre (OT); and
- c. Hospital licensed with dental/ orofacial services

4.2.2.3 Aesthetic surgery can be performed under local anaesthesia in a clinic with a minor surgery room with the following features:

Minor surgery room (MSR) means a clean room/dental surgery room which is located at, or annexed to, a registered healthcare facility, and dedicated for outpatient surgery carried out under local anaesthesia, with provisions for adequate lighting, suction apparatus, diathermy and basic patient monitoring and resuscitation equipment.

4.2.2.4 Procedures under general anaesthesia are to be performed in licensed premises.

## **5. LIST OF OROFACIAL AESTHETIC PRACTICES**

This list reflects the aesthetic treatment and procedures that are supported by moderate to high levels of scientific evidence and/or have local dental expert consensus that the procedures are well-established and acceptable. The procedures are categorized based on their level of invasiveness and the required qualifications of the practitioner. In view of varying levels of treatment complexity, potential complications and the need for formal training, the procedures are grouped under two (2) major categories.

### **SCHEDULE 1**

(For General Dental Practitioners and Non-Oral & Maxillofacial Surgery Dental Specialists)

These are non-invasive or minimally invasive procedures that can be carried out by dental practitioners who have fulfilled the required training and credentialing standards:

- Chemical or liquid peels
- Botulinum toxin injection
- Filler injection (excluding silicone and free fat grafting)

## **SCHEDULE 2**

(For Oral and Maxillofacial Surgeon)

Schedule 2 comprises both non-invasive/ minimally invasive and invasive aesthetic procedures. Oral and maxillofacial surgeon are eligible to perform procedures listed under this schedule, subject to the fulfilment of specific experience and training requirements, particularly for invasive procedures.

Non-invasive/minimally invasive

- Chemical or liquid peels
- Botulinum toxin injection
- Filler injection
- Microdermabrasion
- Thread lift
- Lasers
- Intense pulsed light
- Radiofrequency, Infrared and other devices e.g. for skin tightening procedures
- Photodynamic / Photopneumatic therapy
- External Lipolysis of the Maxillofacial region (heat/ ultrasound)
- Sclerotherapy

b) Invasive

These procedures shall only be performed by oral and maxillofacial surgeons who have a minimum of three (3) years of post-specialisation clinical experience, along with documented evidence of

relevant surgical training and/or clinical exposure to the specific procedures.

- Blepharoplasty (including double eyelid)
- Free fat grafting
- Aesthetic Oro-Maxillofacial Implants (excluding dental implants)
- Submental Fat Reduction
- Lipolysis of Maxillofacial region
- Rhytidectomy (Facelift)
- Aesthetic Rhinoplasty
- Dermabrasion (Mechanical)
- Otoplasty
- Brow lift

## **6. TRAINING MODULE**

General dental practitioners and non-oral maxillofacial surgery specialists who intend to venture into orofacial aesthetic practice are required to undergo structured training as prescribed in 6.1. An overview of the training requirement for these dental practitioners is provided in **Appendix 1**.

General dental practitioners can embark on orofacial training after completing a minimum of three (3) years of clinical practice. However, a minimum of five (5) years of clinical experience as a dental practitioner is required as a prerequisite for orofacial aesthetic practice.

## **6.1 Orofacial Aesthetic Training Module for Schedule 1**

This course comprises of:

- i. Orofacial Aesthetic Non-Clinical Practice Module
- ii. Orofacial Aesthetic Clinical Practice Modules

### **6.1.1 Orofacial Aesthetic Non-Clinical Practice Module**

The Introductory Module is a comprehensive introduction to the understanding of the basic sciences, ethics, safety and medico-legal issues related to Orofacial Aesthetic Practice. It provides fundamental knowledge and is a prerequisite for the subsequent Orofacial Aesthetic Practice Modules. This module will be conducted over a minimum period of accumulative 30 hours of lecture time. Upon completion of the Non-Clinical Practice Module, candidates will be assessed and a Certificate of Completion (COC) be awarded to the successful candidate. The validity of the COC for Orofacial Aesthetic Non-Clinical Practice Module will be for a period of 12 months.

The course outline should include:

- a. Theory
  - Lectures for a minimum duration of 30 hours.
  - Basic science with specific focus on anatomy

of the head and neck, the facial ageing process, skin pathology and clinical dermatology, physiology and pharmacology of botulinum toxin and dermal fillers.

- Full spectrum of facial rejuvenation therapies.
- Criteria in patient selection, basic delivery techniques of the drugs, management of complication, phlebotomy technique, ethics and medicolegal, patient safety (medical emergency), instrumentations and clinic setup, clinical dermatology.

#### b. Assessment

- A written assessment is conducted after the initial introductory module to gauge the candidate's understanding on facial rejuvenation therapy. Upon successfully completing this course the candidate is awarded the Certificate of Completion (COC).

### **6.1.2 Orofacial Aesthetic Clinical Practice Modules**

The clinical training module for Schedule 1 will be conducted over a minimum duration of 14 days. Upon completion of this module, a Certificate of Training (COT) will be awarded to the successful candidate.

## **Clinical Training**

- Demo – live demonstration (drug preparation and administration of drug on patient, phlebotomy)
- Candidates are required to treat patients under supervision of the trainer. The trainer to trainee ratio should not exceed a ratio of 1:5.
- The candidates are required to treat at least three (3) patients with all the procedures of Schedule 1 in a period of two (2) weeks post clinical training with guidance / mentorship from their supervisors/trainers in the accredited training facility.
- All patients' pictures and records are to be endorsed by the trainer for the two weeks post treatment review.
- The clinical training itself must include the management of any complications that may arise from the procedures.
- Upon completion of 14 days' training the candidate will be awarded the Certificate of Training (COT).

## **Provisional Practice Phase**

- Upon completing both the COC and COT, candidates are given provisional rights to practice orofacial aesthetic procedures in their practice for a duration of up to 12 months to fulfil the minimum required cases as per **Appendix 2**.
- A logbook documenting treated patients within the 12-month period must be maintained. Each case

must include complete documentation, including pre- and post-treatment photographs for evaluation by the training providers/ trainers.

- Upon fulfilling these requirements and successful logbook evaluation by the accredited training providers or trainers, practitioners may submit their application for registration in the Orofacial Aesthetic Registry to the MDC. The application will be subject to evaluation in accordance with the process outlined in paragraph 9.

## **6.2 Orofacial Aesthetic Training Module for Schedule 2**

Oral and maxillofacial surgeons are not classified under Schedule 1 and are therefore exempted from completing the Schedule 1 (non-invasive) training modules. This exemption is granted as the knowledge and competencies outlined in Schedule 1 are already comprehensively covered during their specialist training and form relevant exposure in the surgical practice within the region.

However, a dental practitioner registered as an OMFS specialist who intends to practice procedures in Schedule 2 (invasive) should have at least a minimum of three (3) years of clinical experience in oral and maxillofacial surgery. For certain advanced procedures, additional or enhanced clinical training is required to ensure patient safety and dental practitioner competency.



Oral and Maxillofacial Surgeons fulfilling these requirements of relevant surgical exposure or specific training, may submit their application for registration in the Orofacial Aesthetic Registry to the MDC. The application will be subject to evaluation in accordance with the process outlined in paragraph 9.

## **7. REQUIREMENTS FOR COURSE PROVIDERS OF AESTHETIC FACIAL PROCEDURES FOR DENTAL PRACTITIONERS**

**7.1** Aesthetic courses from medical and dental should be conducted by registered CPD providers with the Malaysian Medical Council (MMC) or MDC. All relevant clinical courses should be in a medical / dental training facility or hospital facility.

### **7.2 Clinical Training**

Minimum requirements for the conduct of live demonstration via visual and audio recordings on non-invasive and /or minimally invasive procedures for the part of the course where patient treatment is involved, practitioners shall comply with the Code of Professional Conduct and at the premises registered/ licensed. The live demonstration should be held in a public health care facility or in a healthcare facility licensed or registered under the Act 586.

Auditorium or seminar rooms with portable dental chairs or treatment beds for clinical demonstration are not allowed.

### **7.2.1 Documentation**

- a) There must be proper patient registration and records (history, physical examination, consent and treatment).
- b) Informed consent must be obtained from the patient before treatment procedures.
- c) The record must be kept by the dental practitioner doing most of the orofacial aesthetic procedures and there must be a follow-up by the same dental practitioner in his practice after the course.
- d) If the course trainer demonstrating the orofacial aesthetic procedures is a foreign dental practitioner /medical practitioner with Temporary Practicing Certificate (TPC), the course organizer must designate a locally registered dental practitioner to assume responsibility of the patient.

### **7.2.2 Treatment area**

- a) Treatment must be done in a clinical setting.
- b) Strict infection control guidelines should be adhered at all times.
- c) Compliance to the Fifth Schedule of Private Healthcare Facilities and Services (Private Medical Clinics or Private Dental Clinics) Regulations 2006 and Eighth Schedule of Private Healthcare Facilities and Services

(Private Hospitals and Other Private Healthcare Facilities) Regulations 2006.

**7.3** Minimum requirements to conduct relevant live demonstrations on patients on **invasive procedures** are limited to hospitals or teaching institutions only.

## **8. LECTURERS AND PRINCIPAL CLINICAL TRAINER**

**8.1** The organizer is responsible to ensure that all lecturers for Orofacial Aesthetic **Non-Clinical Practice** Module for **Schedule 1** are qualified presenters/lecturers in conversance in the relevant area.

**8.2** The organizer is responsible to ensure that all trainers for Orofacial Aesthetic **Clinical Practice** Modules for **Schedule 1** are presenters/lecturers in conversance in the relevant area.

**8.3** Dental or/and medical practitioner conducting the training must have a valid practicing certificate from MDC or MMC.

**8.4** Foreign trainers must show proof of relevant training and /or experience. The trainer/s must also show proof of having conducted training for a minimum of three (3) years.

## **9. REGISTRATION OF OROFACIAL AESTHETIC DENTAL PRACTITIONER**

The MDC will hold a committee for the registration process and approval is under the authority of the MDC (subsection 5(f) of Dental Act 2018 [Act 804]).

**9.1** Dental surgeons who intend to practice orofacial aesthetic procedures are required to submit an application to MDC. As part of the application process, the practitioner shall provide evidence of having completed satisfactory training through an accredited programme by providing the COC, COT and a verified logbook.

**9.2** Non-oral and maxillofacial dental specialists who intend to practice orofacial aesthetic procedures are required to apply to MDC. The applicant is required to submit evidence of satisfactory completion of an accredited training programme by providing the COC, COT and a verified logbook during the application process.

**9.3** Oral and maxillofacial surgeons who intend to practice orofacial aesthetic procedures are required to apply to MDC. The applicant shall provide proof of relevant surgical training or exposure to the specific procedures.

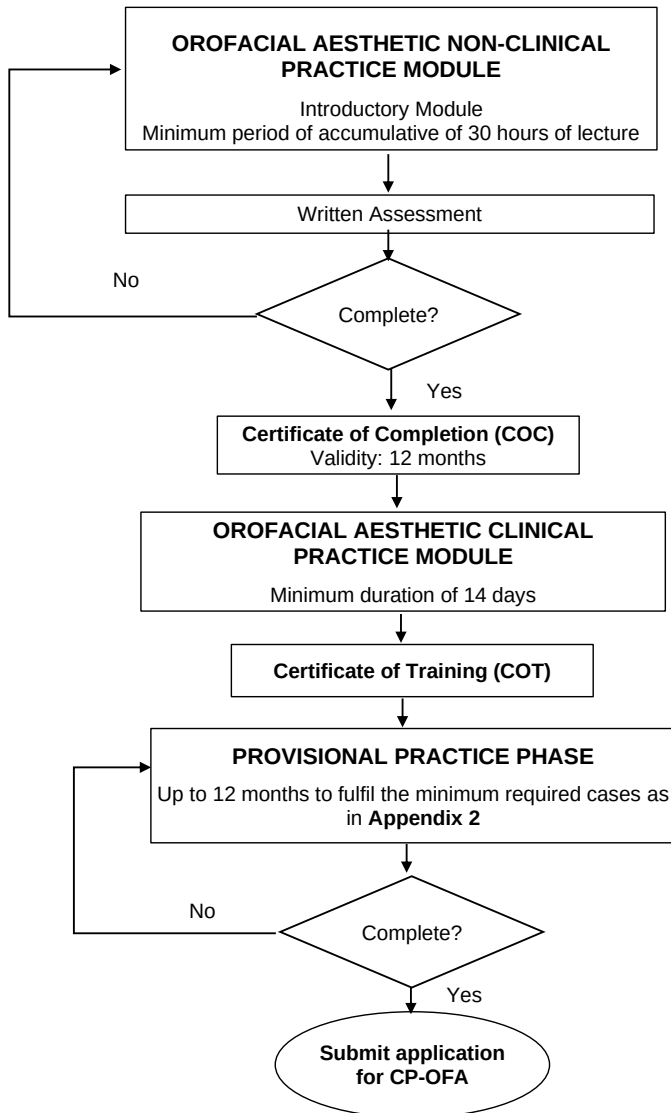
**9.4** The MDC will issue a Credentialing and Privileging in Oro-Facial Aesthetic (CP-OFA) certificate to each successful candidate that satisfies the stipulated

requirements. CP-OFA is valid for a period of five (5) years.

- 9.5 The Applicants may renew the CP-OFA with proof of Continuous Professional Development (CPD). A minimum of 20 CPD points or proof of relevant CME/CDE courses accumulated over the five (5) previous years.
- 9.6 A summary of the overall registration process is provided in **Appendix 3**.
- 9.7 An overview of the scope of practice for dental practitioners registered with CP-OFA is outlined in **Appendix 4**.
- 9.8 MDC reserves the right to review any privileges granted if a complaint is received or if there is evidence of unsafe practice or professional misconduct. MDC may suspend or remove the name of the dental practitioner and/or facility from the Orofacial Aesthetic Registry if a breach of the Act 804 or the MDC Code of Professional Conduct is established.

## Appendix 1

### Oro-facial Aesthetic Training Requirement for General Dental Practitioner and Non-Oral and Maxillofacial Surgeon Dental Specialist



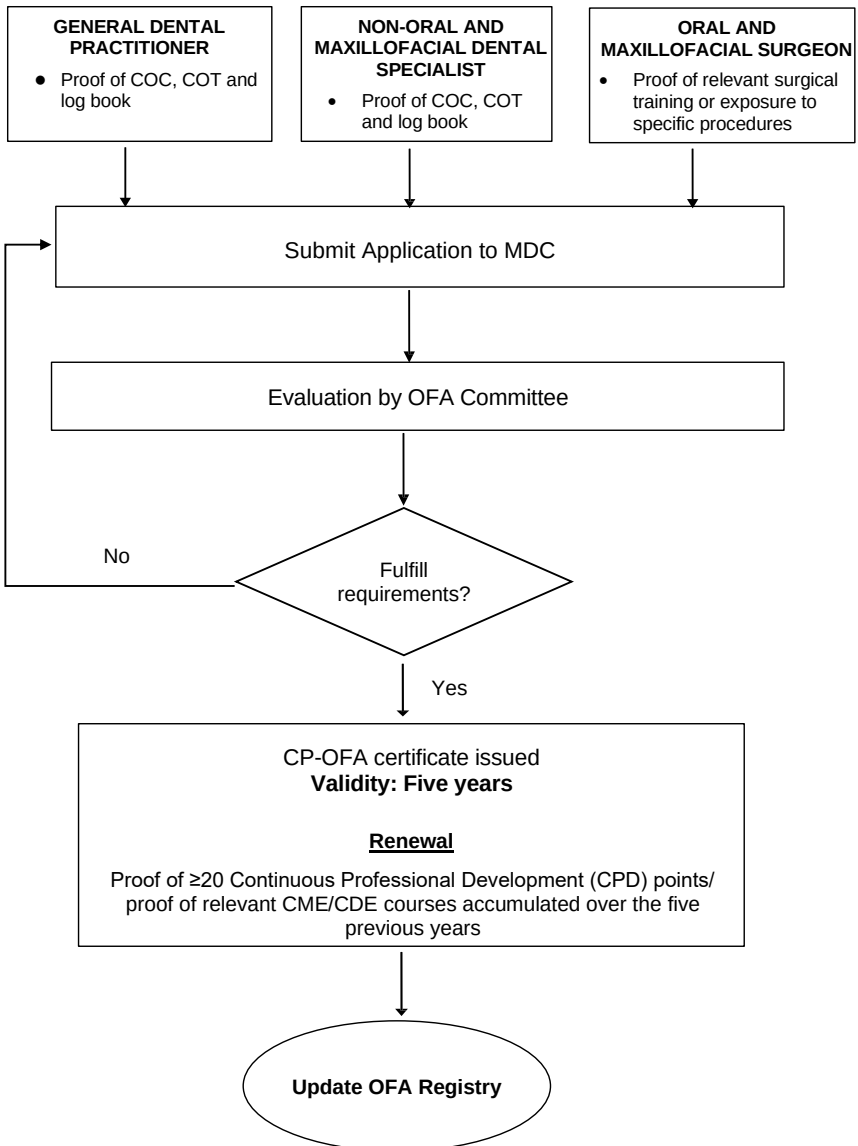
## Appendix 2

### Minimum Case Requirements for General Dental Practitioners and Non-Oral Maxillofacial Surgery Specialists

| PROCEDURES<br>(SCHEDULE 1<br>ONLY)                            | REQUISITE<br>NUMBER OF<br>PROCEDURE<br>PERFORMED | PREMISES                                    | CONDITION |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Chemical or<br>liquid peels                                   | 20                                               | Registered<br>Dental<br>Clinic/<br>Practice | COC & COT |
| Botulinum<br>toxin injection                                  | 20                                               | Registered<br>Dental<br>Clinic/<br>Practice | COC & COT |
| Filler injection<br>excluding<br>silicone and fat<br>grafting | 20                                               | Registered<br>Dental<br>Clinic/<br>Practice | COC & COT |

## Appendix 3

### PROCESS OF REGISTRATION FOR OROFACIAL AESTHETIC PRACTITIONER





### Scope of Practice for Registered Orofacial Aesthetic Dental Practitioners with CP-OFA

| General Dental Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                  | Non-Oral and Maxillofacial Surgeon Dental Specialist                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Oral and Maxillofacial Surgeons                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Chemical or liquid peels</li><li>- Botulinum toxin (Botox) injection</li><li>- Filler injection (excluding silicone and free fat grafting)</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Chemical or liquid peels</li><li>- Botulinum toxin (Botox) injection</li><li>- Filler injection</li><li>- Microdermabrasion</li><li>- Thread lift</li><li>- Lasers</li><li>- Intense pulsed light</li><li>- Radiofrequency, Infrared and other devices e.g for skin tightening procedures.</li><li>- Photodynamic/ Photopneumatic therapy</li><li>- External Lipolysis</li><li>- Sclerotherapy</li></ul> | Non-invasive/ minimally invasive                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Invasive |
|                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Blepharoplasty (including double eyelid)</li><li>- Free fat grafting</li><li>- Aesthetic Oro-maxillofacial implants (excluding dental implants)</li><li>- Submental Fat Reduction</li><li>- Lipolysis of Maxillofacial region</li><li>- Rhytidectomy (Facelift)</li><li>- Aesthetic Rhinoplasty</li><li>- Dermabrasion (Mechanical)</li><li>- Otoplasty</li><li>- Brow lift</li></ul> |          |

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2. American Board of Facial Esthetics Curriculum Guidelines and Standards for Facial Esthetics Education in Dentistry (2012).
3. Guidelines on Aesthetic Facial Procedures for Dental Practitioners (2021), Singapore Dental Council.
4. Professional Standards for Cosmetic Practice (2016), Royal College of Surgeons England.

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